

Code of Conduct

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Owner: Legal and Compliance

Applies to: All employees, contractors and anyone acting for Northwind

Purpose

This code sets the minimum standard of behaviour for everyone acting on behalf of Northwind Systems. Local law takes precedence wherever it is stricter.

Respect at work

Northwind does not tolerate harassment, discrimination, bullying or retaliation. This applies in offices, at remote work locations, at company events, and in every company communication channel including Slack and email.

Conflicts of interest

Declare any outside employment, board position, or financial interest in a supplier, customer or competitor. Declarations go to Legal and Compliance within 14 days of the interest arising. Holding less than 1 percent of a publicly traded company does not require declaration.

Gifts and hospitality

You may accept gifts with a value under 100 US dollars. Gifts valued between 100 and 250 dollars require manager approval and must be recorded in the gift register. Gifts above 250 dollars must be declined. Cash and cash equivalents may never be accepted, at any value.

Confidential information

Company information, customer data and employee data may only be used for the purpose it was collected for. Do not paste confidential information into external tools or services that have not been approved by IT and Legal. The current approved list is in the AI and External Tools Policy (NW-POL-066).

Accurate records

Never falsify a record, a timesheet, an expense claim or a customer communication. Financial records must reflect what actually happened.

Reporting a concern

Raise concerns with your manager, with People Operations, or through the anonymous ethics line. Reports are acknowledged within 3 business days. The detailed investigation procedure is maintained by People Operations.

Consequences

Breaches may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination and, where relevant, referral to law enforcement.